

Lab 02 — Design Principles and Prompt Refinement

Course: Generative AI for Adobe Photoshop (C16) **Version:** v7 · 21 August 2026

Scenario

A creative studio wants a poster-ready yarn-art visual with one strong headline zone.

Objective

Use Photoshop layout evidence to refine a generated visual against hierarchy, balance and contrast criteria.

Supplied Photoshop/JPEG files

- `structure-reference.jpg`
- `structure-reference.psd`

Detailed procedure

1. Open `structure-reference.psd` and immediately save `lab02-working.psd`.
2. Inspect layer names, canvas ratio, dominant lines and negative-space zones.
3. Create guides for a primary focal area, headline zone and safe margins.
4. Write a Firefly prompt that preserves the structural intent while changing subject or material.
5. Generate at least two candidates and place them as separate Smart Object layers.
6. Add editable placeholder type to test hierarchy; do not embed essential copy in generated pixels.
7. Compare scale, alignment, value contrast and breathing room at Fit and thumbnail views.
8. Retain the stronger candidate, name all layers and export `lab02-poster.jpg`.

Evidence to retain

Layered PSD, exported JPEG and a short comparison note covering the design principles.

Acceptance criteria

- ☐ PSD contains guides, editable type and separate candidate layers.
- ☐ The final hierarchy remains clear at thumbnail size.
- ☐ Comparison note cites at least three explicit design criteria.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers panel prove that the workflow remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?